

Unitree's \$50B Humanoid IPO, US-Canada Tariffs Collapse, and the Ghost Job Crackdown

TL;DR

- ▶ Unitree's humanoid robot claims to have beaten Usain Bolt's speed record days before a \$50B Shanghai IPO where shares jumped over 460%.
- ▶ US-Canada trade talks collapsed, triggering 50% tariffs on \$20 billion of Canadian goods.
- ▶ New state legislation is targeting "ghost job" listings — roughly 1 in 5 online postings have no real hiring intent.

AI NEWS

the news — then what it means for you

Unitree's humanoid robot claims to beat Usain Bolt's speed record days before its \$50 billion Shanghai IPO. The company's 'Superman' robot reportedly hit 12.7 m/s versus Bolt's 12.4 m/s and cleared a 2-meter vertical jump; shares then soared over 460% on debut, valuing Unitree near \$50 billion. The speed claims have not been independently verified.

What it means for you: A vivid data point for AI-adoption conversations: physical AI (robotics) is now drawing IPO-scale capital, not just LLM hype. Useful context if clients ask where AI investment is actually flowing.

Source: Superhuman AI

Generalist AI's new model lets a robot learn a physical skill from a single demo. GEN-1.5 succeeds on its first try 59% of the time after watching one 3-12 second demonstration, rising to 83% after a few minutes of practice, prompting some to call it an early sign of "physical general intelligence," though Generalist says the skills are still developmental.

What it means for you: One-shot skill transfer from minimal data is the same capability jump that made LLMs useful for knowledge work. Worth watching for the same pattern showing up in agentic software tools.

Source: Superhuman AI

Robotics investment kept accelerating this week. SoftBank put \$200M into Gravis Robotics to automate construction machinery, Waymo won approval to expand robotaxis across the Bay Area, LA, Sacramento and San Diego, and China is staging a World Humanoid Robot Games with over 2,000 robots.

What it means for you: Background context only — robotics funding and deployment are both accelerating in parallel, but none of this changes near-term software-AI client work.

Source: Superhuman AI

Lawmakers are cracking down on "ghost job" listings. Roughly 1 in 5 online job postings each quarter have no real hiring intent, per Greenhouse data, and 81% of recruiters admit their employers have posted them. New York passed a bill awaiting signature requiring hiring-timeline disclosure; New Jersey, Pennsylvania, Kentucky and California are weighing similar bills, and Texas's AG opened an investigation into LinkedIn.

PM angle: Directly relevant if you advise clients on hiring or employer brand trust — a live compliance and reputational issue worth flagging before disclosure rules land in more states.

Conversation starter: *Have we checked whether any of our open reqs would fail a "ghost job" disclosure law if one landed in our state?*

Source: Morning Brew

US-Canada trade talks collapsed, triggering 50% tariffs on \$20 billion of Canadian goods. A draft deal would have lowered US tariffs on Canadian steel, aluminum and autos in exchange for Canada dropping retaliation, but talks fell apart before the deadline; Canada's PM says it will retaliate "dollar for dollar."

PM angle: Directly relevant for clients with cross-border supply chains or Canadian vendors — budget and sourcing assumptions made even a month ago may already be stale.

Conversation starter: *Are any of our clients sourcing from Canada exposed to this new 50% tariff, and have we flagged it to them yet?*

Source: Morning Brew

TikTok agreed to pay \$400 million to settle DOJ child-privacy claims. The settlement resolves federal allegations tied to how the platform handled children's data.

PM angle: A useful data point when advising clients on data-privacy exposure — regulators are still actively pursuing large platform settlements over children's data specifically.

Conversation starter: *With TikTok's \$400M child-privacy settlement, is it worth revisiting how our own products handle minors' data?*

Source: Morning Brew

Seoul's Incheon Airport overtook Dubai as the world's busiest international hub in H1 2026, handling 38.4 million international travelers and ending Dubai's 12-year reign. The shift follows a steep drop in Middle East transit traffic tied to the Iran war, with much of it rerouting through Asia.

PM angle: No direct relevance to your work, general awareness only.

Conversation starter: *Anyone else notice more layovers routing through Seoul instead of Dubai lately?*

Source: Morning Brew

People over 100 show elevated levels of a rare cancer-fighting immune cell, per a new Japanese study comparing blood from adults aged 70–99, 100–109, and 110+. The oldest group had the highest ratio of these CD4 CTL cells despite showing no signs of cancer, hinting at a late-life immune adaptation tied to longevity.

PM angle: No direct relevance to your work, general awareness only.

Conversation starter: *Did you see the study on why some people's immune systems stay sharp past 100? Kind of wild.*

Source: 1440 Daily Digest